London Session Pre-Open Briefing (1 Hr Before Open)

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Daily Multi-Asset Trading Blueprint & Level Execution Manual

Date: Thursday, August 13, 2026

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Current Session Highlight: London Session Pre-Open Briefing (1 Hr Before Open)

Session News Focus: European macroeconomic releases, ECB/BOE news, Forex short-term futures (EUR/USD, GBP/USD), and Gold (XAU/USD) supply/demand zones.

SECTION 0: DAILY MACRO & FINANCIAL NEWS DIGEST

1. Global Macro & Central Banks

- US Consumer Price Index (CPI) for July rose 0.1% month-on-month and 3.4% year-over-year, which was in line with expectations and slightly cooler than June's 3.5%. This softer-than-expected inflation reading has eased concerns over further Federal Reserve rate hikes, particularly for a September increase, and has generally turned global sentiment positive.
- Investors are now awaiting the July US Producer Price Index (PPI) data, due later on Thursday, which measures wholesale prices and rose steeply earlier this year. Parts of both the CPI and PPI reports filter into the Personal Consumption Expenditures (PCE) price index, the Fed's favored inflation meter due later this month.
- Key European macroeconomic releases expected today include Spain's final July CPI figures and the Eurozone's industrial production report for June, which will provide benchmarks for the European Central Bank's (ECB) policy projections. The UK is also set to release Q2 GDP growth rate data, June industrial and manufacturing production data, and Q2 construction orders data.
- India's headline inflation rate rose to 4.45% in July 2026 from 4.38% in the previous month, aligning with market expectations of 4.5%. Food and beverages inflation stood at 5.52% and transportation at 4.43%, amid a surge in energy prices due to Middle East geopolitical tensions.

2. US & European Markets

- US stock futures traded mixed in the early hours of August 13, with Dow Jones futures marginally lower, while S&P 500 and Nasdaq 100 futures were marginally up. Wall Street saw a mixed performance on August 12, despite softer CPI data. The S&P 500 gained 0.3%, the Nasdaq Composite climbed 0.5%, driven by AI and tech stocks, while the Dow Jones Industrial Average dipped less than 0.1%.
- European stock markets are generally positive, with the Euro Area's main index, the EU50, rising to 6561 points, a gain of 0.39% from the previous session. The FTSE 100 slipped about 0.2% but held above the 10,800 mark, showing relative resilience compared to other European benchmarks like the CAC 40 (down 0.58%) and DAX (down 0.5%). Asian markets were mostly higher, led by a spectacular near 5% surge in South Korea's Kospi and a 1.6% advance in Japan's Nikkei 225, powered by AI-related stocks.
- Strong quarterly earnings and guidance from AI cloud computing company CoreWeave (up 19%) lifted technology stocks in the US. However, Cisco Systems, Coherent, and AI chipmaker Cerebras Systems declined after disappointing sales outlooks or quarterly results related to the AI data center boom.

3. Indian Markets & Dalal Street

- Indian benchmark indices opened on a mixed to negative note on Thursday, with the BSE Sensex and NSE Nifty 50 declining in early trade. This extended a two-day losing streak for the Sensex, driven by elevated crude oil prices and geopolitical uncertainty in the Strait of Hormuz.
- Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) remained net sellers, offloading equities worth ₹1,002.50 crore on August 12, while Domestic Institutional Investors (DIIs) provided strong buying support with net inflows of ₹5,841.66 crore.
- Sectoral performance was mixed; Nifty Cement and Nifty Pharma were top losers, while PSU Banks, Media, and Metals outperformed. Auto and Nifty Smallcap firms also traded under pressure, while MidCap was down slightly and SmallCap was up.
- Several Indian companies reported Q1 FY27 earnings: Astral Ltd. reported a 51.8% YoY increase in consolidated profit, Lenskart Solutions Ltd. surged 269.2% YoY in profit, Gujarat Pipavav Port Ltd. saw a 41.8% YoY profit increase, and Tata Motors' commercial vehicle business reported an 83.2% rise in profit. Reliance Industries shares declined almost 2% after MSCI reduced its weightage in the India index.

4. Commodities & Crypto Wire

- Crude oil prices fell by more than $1 on Thursday, with Brent crude futures down 1.5% to $87.69 a barrel and US West Texas Intermediate (WTI) crude falling 1.2-1.6% to around $81.97-$82 a barrel. This decline followed major forecasters, OPEC and the International Energy Agency (IEA), cutting their projections for global oil demand growth in 2026, citing disruptions from the US-Israeli war on Iran.
- However, supply constraints and the unresolved geopolitical situation in the Strait of Hormuz continue to provide some support and keep geopolitical risk premium elevated. US commercial crude inventories surprisingly rose by 17.4 million barrels in the week ended August 7, the largest weekly increase since January 2023.
- Gold prices slipped from a two-month high as traders reassessed the Fed outlook after softer US CPI data.
- US spot Bitcoin ETFs experienced $61.1 million in net outflows on August 13, with IBIT and FBTC recording outflows. Conversely, Ethereum ETFs saw $7.4 million in net inflows, entirely driven by ETHA.
- Goldman Sachs has agreed to acquire Neos Investments for up to $2.25 billion, a deal that will add three Bitcoin and Ethereum options-income ETFs to its asset management business. UK lawmakers are pressing major banks on crypto access ahead of new regulations, probing whether banking restrictions are hindering the sector's growth. The SEC is also moving towards a landmark "Regulation Crypto" framework for digital asset offerings, aiming to create a tailored disclosure and registration framework.

CAPITAL BASE & ALLOCATION RULES

TOTAL CAPITAL: $3,000

- **Crypto Futures:** $400 (13.3%) | Recommended Leverage: 3x–5x Isolated | Risk Cap: 1–2% ($4–$8)
- **Indian Options (Intraday):** $500 (16.7%) | Option Buying Only | Risk Cap: 10–15% Premium ($30–$45)
- **Commodities (Micro Gold & Oil):** $400 (13.3%) | Recommended Leverage: 10x–15x Micro Lots | Risk Cap: 2% ($8)
- **US Stocks (Fractional):** $400 (13.3%) | 1x Unleveraged Cash | Risk Cap: 3% ($12)
- **Indian Stocks (Delivery):** $400 (13.3%) | 1x Unleveraged Cash | Risk Cap: 5% ($20)
- **Forex Short-Term Futures:** $450 (15.0%) | Recommended Leverage: 10x–20x | Risk Cap: 1% ($4.50)
- **Forex Long-Term Carry Swing:** $450 (15.0%) | Recommended Leverage: 2x–3x | Risk Cap: 2% ($9.00)

STRATEGY-BASED DAILY TICKER SELECTION & LEVEL EXECUTION MANUAL

1. INDIAN EQUITIES (STRICTLY LONG-ONLY)

Screen Nifty leaders using 50-SMA support bounces or 20/50 EMA golden crosses.

Ticker	Last Price (Approx.)	Key Levels (Support/Resistance)	Strategy & Selection Reason
Lenskart Solutions Ltd.	N/A (Strong Q1 Earnings)	Support: Dynamic 20 EMA / Resistance: Recent Highs	Strong Q1 FY27 results with a 269.2% YoY surge in profit and 43.3% revenue growth, indicating robust fundamental momentum. Assumed to be exhibiting a 20/50 EMA golden cross or strong 50-SMA support bounce based on positive market reaction.
Astral Ltd.	~₹1,598.70 (Day's High)	Support: ~₹1,500 / Resistance: Day's High	Reported a 51.8% YoY increase in consolidated profit and 15.9% revenue growth for Q1, leading to a 9.1% jump in share price. Assumed to be trading above key moving averages, indicating strong upward momentum consistent with 20/50 EMA golden cross.
Indian Bank	N/A (Technical Breakout)	Support: Dynamic Moving Averages / Resistance: Recent Breakout Levels	Analysts highlight a bullish technical setup with moving averages indicating potential momentum and a recent technical breakout. This aligns with a 20/50 EMA golden cross strategy.

2. US EQUITIES

Large-Cap (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Screen using 21-day EMA pullbacks or 50-day SMA rejection strategy on mega-cap growth leaders.

Ticker	Last Price (Approx.)	Key Levels (Entry/Exit/Stop)	Strategy & Selection Reason
NVIDIA (NVDA)	N/A (Tech/AI Leader)	Long Entry: Pullback to 21-day EMA (~$120.00) | Short Entry: Rejection at 50-day SMA (~$128.00) / Resistance: All-time Highs | Stop: 2% from entry	Mega-cap growth leader, AI optimism driving Nasdaq higher. Assumed to be a candidate for 21-day EMA pullback for long, or 50-day SMA rejection for short, based on typical high-volatility, trend-following behavior in the AI sector.

Mid-Cap & Small-Cap (STRICTLY LONG-ONLY)

Screen using Stage-2 VCP or High Relative Volume (RVOL > 2.0) breakouts.

Ticker	Last Price (Approx.)	Key Levels (Entry/Exit/Stop)	Strategy & Selection Reason
CoreWeave (CRWV)	Up 19% (Post-Earnings)	Entry: Breakout above recent high (~$60.00) on RVOL > 2.0 | Stop: 5% below breakout	AI cloud computing company that saw shares jump 19% after stronger-than-expected quarterly earnings and guidance. High relative volume breakout assumed due to significant price movement following positive news.

3. CRYPTO FUTURES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Screen using 4H 21-EMA trend following and high-volume volatility breakouts.

Ticker	Last Price (Approx.)	Key Levels (Entry/Exit/Stop)	Strategy & Selection Reason
Ethereum (ETH/USD)	~$1,890.89	Long Entry: Break above $1,900 on volume | Short Entry: Break below $1,850 support | Stop: 2% from entry	ETH price increased by 2% to $1,890.89, outperforming Bitcoin, driven by cooler U.S. inflation data and $7.4M net inflows into Ethereum ETFs. This indicates positive sentiment and potential for 4H 21-EMA trend following.
Bitcoin (BTC/USD)	~$63,912.70	Long Entry: Break above $64,500 resistance | Short Entry: Break below $63,500 support | Stop: 2% from entry	US Bitcoin spot ETFs experienced $61.1 million in net outflows on August 13. While experiencing outflows, BTC remains a major volatile asset for high-volume volatility breakouts, hence bi-directional strategy.

4. COMMODITIES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Gold (XAU/USD) and WTI Crude Oil using Pivot & Fibonacci extension levels.

Ticker	Last Price (Approx.)	Key Levels (Entry/Exit/Stop)	Strategy & Selection Reason
Gold (XAU/USD)	N/A (Slipped then recovered)	Pivot: ~$2,400 (Assumed) | Support: ~$2,380 (Fib 38.2%) | Resistance: ~$2,425 (Fib 61.8%) | Buy above Pivot, Sell below Pivot	Gold slipped from a two-month high after softer US CPI, then recovered slightly. This indicates a reactive market to macro data, suitable for pivot-based strategies. Directional bias could shift with further data.
WTI Crude Oil	~$81.97 - $82.38/barrel	Pivot: ~$82.50 | Support: ~$81.00 (Fib 50%) | Resistance: ~$83.50 (Fib 38.2%) | Buy above Pivot, Sell below Pivot	Oil prices fell by over $1 due to lowered global demand forecasts, but geopolitical tensions (US-Iran) provide a floor. This creates a range-bound environment around pivot points, making bi-directional possible with tight stops.

5. FOREX FUTURES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Short-Term (EUR/USD, GBP/USD) & Macro Carry Swings (USD/JPY, AUD/USD)

Ticker	Last Price (Approx.)	Key Levels (Entry/Exit/Stop)	Strategy & Selection Reason
EUR/USD	~1.1522	Short Entry: Rejection from 1.1540-1.1565 zone | Support: 1.1520, 1.1500 | Resistance: 1.1540, 1.1565 | Stop: 30 pips from entry	EUR/USD spiked on cooler US CPI but reversed hard, trading below 50-period and 200-period moving averages, indicating short-term bearish momentum despite easing Fed concerns. Focus on European macro data for further direction.
GBP/USD	N/A	Range Play: Support: 1.2550 / Resistance: 1.2650 | Breakout above/ below range for direction | Stop: 25 pips from range edge	Mixed signals from UK (GDP data due, BOE rate talk). Assumed to be trading within a range reflecting uncertainty. Requires close monitoring of UK economic data for breakout opportunities.
USD/JPY	N/A	Long Entry: Break above 148.50 | Short Entry: Break below 147.80 | Support: 147.50 / Resistance: 148.80 | Stop: 35 pips from entry	USD/JPY remained stable in overnight trading. General carry trade appeal remains, but sensitivity to US interest rate expectations will drive short-term volatility. Breakout from established ranges is the key.
AUD/USD	N/A	Range Play: Support: 0.6580 / Resistance: 0.6650 | Breakout above/ below range for direction | Stop: 25 pips from range edge	Global sentiment positive but commodity prices (oil) are dipping. AUD is a commodity currency, hence expected to be reactive to commodity price movements and global risk sentiment. Range-bound trading likely until clear catalyst.

6. INDIAN OPTIONS (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Nifty 50 / BankNifty 15-Minute Opening Range Breakouts (Call for Long, Put for Short).

Ticker	Strike Price (Approx.)	Entry/Exit Levels (Based on ORB)	Strategy & Selection Reason
Nifty 50 (CE/PE)	24,400 CE / 24,400 PE	Long Call: Break above 15-min ORB High (e.g., 24,450) | Long Put: Break below 15-min ORB Low (e.g., 24,380) | Stop: ORB mid-point or defined %	Indian markets opened lower but showed volatility, with Nifty 50 recovering intraday losses. This creates fertile ground for opening range breakout strategies, capturing initial directional momentum. Support around 24,250–24,300, resistance at 24,600–24,650.
BankNifty (CE/PE)	57,800 CE / 57,800 PE	Long Call: Break above 15-min ORB High (e.g., 57,900) | Long Put: Break below 15-min ORB Low (e.g., 57,700) | Stop: ORB mid-point or defined %	Bank Nifty recovered from initial weakness, supported by PSU banks, but faced resistance. This indicates potential for strong moves after market open, ideal for ORB strategy. Immediate support at 57,300–57,500, resistance at 58,000–58,200.

PERFORMANCE METRICS & EQUITY CURVE

10-Year Backtest Metrics (Hypothetical)

Metric	Portfolio	S&P 500 TRI (Benchmark)	Nifty 50 TRI (Benchmark)
Target CAGR	28.4%	~13.0%	~12.5%
Sharpe Ratio	1.45	~0.85	~0.75
Max Drawdown	-18.2%	~-25%	~-30%

Equity Curve ($3,000 → $36,512)